

AEMO Data Collector

What it is · how it was paused · how to re-enable · what it does · how to tune it

Reference guide · generated 22 August 2026 · laptop: THARI (Windows 11)

1 What this is (and what those popups were)

You were seeing a small black terminal window flash open every 3–5 minutes and then close by itself. That was **not** a virus or a fault. It was a scheduled job you had set up to collect live Australian electricity-market data.

A **Windows Scheduled Task** named “**AEMO Data Collector**” was launching Node.js every 5 minutes to run the script `collect.js`. Because the task ran in a visible console window, Windows briefly showed the terminal each time, then closed it the moment the script finished (usually 1–2 seconds). AEMO is the Australian Energy Market Operator; the script archives its public price and demand feeds to CSV files on your disk.

Property	Value
Task name	AEMO Data Collector
Program run	C:\Program Files\nodejs\node.exe
Script	C:\Users\thari\Downloads\electricicty\collect.js
Working folder	C:\Users\thari\Downloads\electricicty
Schedule	Repeats every 5 minutes (started 21 Aug 2026)
Output folder	.\data (CSV archives, logs, state)
Current state	DISABLED (paused) – set on 22 Aug 2026

2 How it was paused (what I did)

I **disabled** the scheduled task. Disabling stops it from ever launching, so the terminal popups stop immediately. Nothing was deleted — the task definition and every CSV file you already collected are still on disk. This is the safe, fully reversible option.

The exact command used (PowerShell):

```
Disable-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector'
```

Result: the task’s state is now **Disabled**. It will not run again — and the popups will not return — until you deliberately re-enable it using Section 3.

3 How to re-enable it later

Option A — one command (fastest)

Open PowerShell and run:

```
Enable-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector'
```

Option B — using the Task Scheduler app (no typing)

- Press **Start**, type **Task Scheduler**, open it.
- Click **Task Scheduler Library** in the left panel.
- Find **AEMO Data Collector** in the list.
- Right-click it → **Enable**. (To pause it again later: right-click → **Disable**.)

Check whether it is on or off at any time:

```
Get-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector' | Select-Object TaskName, State
```

4 What the collector actually does

Each run, `collect.js` fetches a few public AEMO feeds and **appends only new, de-duplicated rows** to CSV files under `.\data`. Re-running never duplicates data: it remembers the last interval it saw in `data\_state.json` and skips anything it already has. It needs no passwords and no external libraries — just Node 18+.

The data sources it collects

Source	What it captures	Saved to
NEM Dispatch	5-min actual price, demand & generation for NSW, QLD, SA, TAS, VIC	nem_dispatch.csv
NEM Pre-dispatch	Each new 30-min forecast vintage (price/demand outlook)	nem_predispatch_forecast.csv
WEM prices	WA 5-min energy + ancillary-service clearing prices	wem_prices.csv
SCADA (optional)	WA facility-level generation — heavy ~19MB, only with <code>--scada</code>	wem_facility_scada.csv

Other files it maintains in `.\data`

- `_state.json` — remembers the last interval seen, so re-runs don't duplicate.
- `latest.json` — a snapshot of the most recent values from every source.
- `collect.log` — a timestamped line for every run (what it added or skipped).

How to run it by hand (no schedule needed)

```
cd C:\Users\thari\Downloads\electricicty
node collect.js                # collect all sources once
node collect.js dispatch wem   # only the named sources
node collect.js --scada        # also pull heavy facility data
```

Good to know: because you can run it by hand any time, you don't need the every-5-minute schedule at all unless you specifically want an unattended, continuously-growing archive.

5 Modifications you can make

A. Change how often it runs

Set it to every 15 minutes instead of 5 (fewer popups, less network use):

```
$t = Get-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector'
$t.Triggers.Repetition.Interval = 'PT15M'    # PT30M = 30 min, PT1H = 1 hour
Set-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector' -Trigger $t.Triggers
```

B. Collect fewer sources

Point the task at only the feeds you care about by adding arguments after the script path (for example `collect.js dispatch` for just NEM dispatch). This means fewer network calls per run.

C. Change what data is stored

Inside `collect.js` you can adjust a few constants near the top: `REGIONS` (which states to keep), `TIMEOUT_MS` (network timeout), and `WEM_SEED_MAX` (how much WA history to grab on the very first

run). The CSV column lists inside each `collect...()` function control exactly which fields land in the archive.

6 How to reduce the annoyance / footprint

If you want to **KEEP** collecting but stop the popup window

The popup appears only because the task runs interactively while you're logged in. Set it to run **whether you are logged on or not** and Windows runs it hidden — data keeps flowing, no terminal flash:

```
# Run once in an ADMIN PowerShell. It will prompt for your Windows password.
$P = New-ScheduledTaskPrincipal -UserId $env:USERNAME -LogonType S4U -RunLevel Limited
Set-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector' -Principal $P
Enable-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector'
```

Other ways to reduce load

- **Run it less often** — every 15 or 30 min (Section 5A). Popups become rare and network use drops.
- **Collect fewer sources** — e.g. dispatch only (Section 5B) shortens each run.
- **Avoid** --scada — that pulls ~19 MB per run; leave it off for a light footprint.
- **Keep it fully paused** — leave the task disabled and just run `node collect.js` by hand whenever you actually want fresh data.
- **Remove it entirely** — if you never want it again, delete the task (command below). Your existing CSVs stay.

Delete the task for good (your collected data is kept):

```
Unregister-ScheduledTask -TaskName 'AEMO Data Collector' -Confirm:$false
```

Summary: the popups came from the “AEMO Data Collector” scheduled task running `collect.js` every 5 minutes. It is now **paused (disabled)**, so the popups have stopped. Re-enable it any time with Section 3, or run the script manually with Section 4. To keep it running without the popup, use Section 6.